

Paper 1 and Paper 2: Pure Mathematics

To support the co-teaching of this qualification with the AS Mathematics qualification, common content has been highlighted in bold.

Topics	What students need to learn:		
	Content		Guidance
1 Proof	1.1	Understand and use the structure of mathematical proof, proceeding from given assumptions through a series of logical steps to a conclusion; use methods of proof, including: Proof by deduction Proof by exhaustion Disproof by counter example Proof by contradiction (including proof of the irrationality of $\sqrt{2}$ and the infinity of primes, and application to unfamiliar proofs).	Examples of proofs: Proof by deduction e.g. using completion of the square, prove that $n^2 - 6n + 10$ is positive for all values of n or, for example, differentiation from first principles for small positive integer powers of x or proving results for arithmetic and geometric series. This is the most commonly used method of proof throughout this specification Proof by exhaustion Given that p is a prime number such that $3 < p < 25$, prove by exhaustion, that $(p - 1)(p + 1)$ is a multiple of 12. Disproof by counter example e.g. show that the statement "$n^2 - n + 1$ is a prime number for all values of n" is untrue